THE BRIDGE AND THE TORCH

17 MINUTES. FOUR PEOPLE. ONE TORCH.

THE CASE IN ONE LINE
A bridge, a dying torch, four walkers — and a schedule with zero slack.

THE COMPLETE PRODUCTION PACK — STORY · SCRIPT · NARRATION · EVERY PROMPT

WHAT'S INSIDE

One riddle, taken all the way from story to posted video. Every page does one job.

THE CASE
the story, exactly as the viewer hears it

THE QUESTION + THREE HINTS
the hook and the ladder

YOUR MOVE
the pause page — where comments are born

THE REVEAL + WHY IT WORKS
the verified answer, watertight

THE TRAP + COMMENT ENGINEERING
why brains fail it, and how the debate is seeded

CHARACTER & STYLE LOCK
the designs that never change

REFERENCE IMAGE PROMPTS
the stills to generate first

VIDEO PROMPTS 1-6
one clip per page, narration inside each

AGENT MASTER PROMPT
the one prompt that runs the build

NARRATION SCRIPT
every line, in order, with timing

THUMBNAIL
the cover frame that earns the tap

POSTING COPY
titles, caption, pinned comment

EDIT CHECKLIST
the checks before anything posts

AI — WHO DOES WHAT
every step, and whose job it is

THE CASE

Four travellers must cross a narrow bridge at night. The bridge holds at most two people at a time, and nobody may cross without the group's only torch, which must be carried back and forth — it cannot be thrown across.

Alone, the four walkers take 1, 2, 5 and 10 minutes to cross. Two together walk at the slower one's pace — nobody can be carried, hurried or left mid-bridge.

The torch will burn for exactly 17 minutes. If it dies with anyone still on the wrong side, the crossing fails.

THE QUESTION

How do all four cross before the torch dies?

THE QUESTION + THREE HINTS

Open them one at a time. Stop the moment you have it — the last hint nearly gives it away.

THE QUESTION

How do all four cross before the torch dies?

HINT 1

Count the crossings: five trips minimum — three over, two back. The returns must be made by fast walkers only.

HINT 2

The 10-minute walker must cross exactly once, and his slowness must be shared — hidden inside a trip that was already expensive.

HINT 3

Send the two slowest together. It feels wasteful; it is the whole trick. Then budget what remains.

YOUR MOVE

How do all four cross before the torch dies?

Decide your answer now — say it out loud or drop it in the comments — before you turn this page. No going back.

THE REVEAL

THE ANSWER

1 and 2 cross (2). 1 returns (1). 5 and 10 cross together (10). 2 returns (2). 1 and 2 cross (2). Total: exactly 17.

The schedule: the 1- and 2-minute walkers cross — 2 minutes gone. The fastest returns with the torch — 3. Then the 5- and 10-minute walkers cross together — 13 — the 10-minute crossing swallowing the 5-minute one whole. The 2-minute walker returns — 15. The two fast walkers cross a final time — 17, exactly as the torch dies.

The naive plan — fastest walker ferrying everyone — costs 10 + 1 + 5 + 1 + 2 = 19 and fails. Pairing the two slowest is the only move that saves the day, and it saves exactly the 2 minutes needed.

WHY IT WORKS

Every schedule must pay for the 10-minute walker once. The question is whether you also pay separately for the 5. Sending them together merges two debts into one payment — the only real saving available.

The returns are the second discipline: only 1- and 2-minute walkers ever carry the torch back, so the four return-and-shuttle trips cost the minimum possible.

THE TRAP + COMMENT ENGINEERING

THE TRAP, NAMED
The ferry instinct: use the fastest as a taxi. It feels efficient and quietly pays the 5-minute fare in full, alone — two minutes the torch does not have.

This riddle is built to split the comments into two camps. Seed both, then let them argue:

CAMP A SAYS
Team FERRY: 'Send the fastest with everyone, one at a time. The quickest legs should do all the work — 19 minutes is close enough to fix somehow.'

CAMP B SAYS
Team PAIR THE SLOW: 'Cross the 5 and 10 together so you never pay for both. 2+1+10+2+2 — exactly 17.'

PIN THIS COMMENT
Post your full schedule with the running total BEFORE the reveal. Totals must land on 17.

CHARACTER & STYLE LOCK

[VAULT-2D] STYLE LOCK — flat 2D storybook animation, deep-navy night palette with one lime accent, clean shapes, soft moonlight, no text inside the picture except where a prompt says so, vertical 9:16. Characters never change design between clips: generate the reference stills first, then build every clip from them.

LOCK
The four travellers are told apart by coat colour only: lime (1 minute), teal (2), rust (5), grey (10). Colours never swap, and all time figures are drawn in editing.

LOCK
The bridge, gorge and torch never change. The torch flame visibly shrinks across the video — it is the clock, and its size must match the schedule's progress.

LOCK
A pair always walks at the slower traveller's pace; nobody is ever carried, and the torch is always visibly in a crosser's hand.

Never redesign a locked character mid-video. If a generation drifts, regenerate the still — never accept a near-match.

REFERENCE IMAGE PROMPTS

Generate these stills first, in this order, and check each one before any video clip is made.

REF 1
REF-BRIDGE: flat 2D storybook illustration, vertical 9:16, a narrow rope bridge across a dark gorge at night, one torch planted at the near end, deep navy palette, no people, no text.

REF 2
REF-TRAVELLERS: flat 2D storybook illustration, vertical 9:16, four travellers in a line on a plain dark background: a quick young walker in lime, a steady walker in teal, a heavy walker in rust, a slow elder in grey — full bodies, no text.

REF 3
REF-TORCH: a single flaming torch alone on a deep-navy background, flat 2D storybook style, wooden shaft, bright flame, centred, no text.

REF 4
REF-CROSSING: flat 2D storybook illustration, vertical 9:16, two silhouetted travellers crossing a rope bridge side by side with one torch between them, gorge below, night palette, no text.

VIDEO PROMPT 1 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
A narrow rope bridge over a dark gorge at night. Four travellers stand at the near end around a single flaming torch. Slow push-in.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"Four people. One narrow bridge. One torch. And the torch dies in seventeen minutes."

Sound: Wind over a gorge, rope creaking.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

VIDEO PROMPT 2 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
The four travellers in a line, each stepping forward in turn at a visibly different walking pace. The torch flame gutters in the wind.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"They cross in one, two, five and ten minutes. Two together move at the slower pace — and someone must carry the torch back."

Sound: Four sets of footsteps at four speeds.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

VIDEO PROMPT 3 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
The fastest traveller escorts the slowest across, returns, escorts the next — a quick montage that visibly eats the torch down to a stub.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"The obvious plan — fastest person ferries everyone — takes nineteen minutes. The torch dies with one traveller stranded."

Sound: Hurried crossings, the torch sputtering.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

VIDEO PROMPT 4 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
Freeze on the bridge with all four back at the start and the torch burning low. Leave the lower third open for the pause.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"Find a seventeen-minute schedule. Write it in the comments before the reveal."

Sound: Silence, one rope creak.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

VIDEO PROMPT 5 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
The five-minute and ten-minute travellers cross side by side as one slow silhouette, the torch between them, while the gorge wind bends the flame.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"Send the one and the two across. The one returns. Now the trick: send the five and the ten together — the slow crossing hides inside itself."

Sound: Slow matched footsteps, wind rising.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

VIDEO PROMPT 6 OF 6

PICTURE — what Flow builds
The two fast travellers step off the far end together as the torch flame shrinks and dies in the same instant. Dawn cracks the horizon.

NARRATION — generated inside this clip
"The two returns, the fast pair crosses last, and the torch dies exactly as they arrive. Seventeen. Follow for daily riddles."

Sound: The flame dies — dawn birds.

One tiny action only. If the clip drifts, cut to the verified still and use a slow zoom instead.

AGENT MASTER PROMPT

Paste this whole prompt to the agent (Google Antigravity) with this book. It runs the video build end to end.

MASTER PROMPT

You are producing a 60-second vertical riddle video, 'THE BRIDGE AND THE TORCH'. Use the story, hints and reveal in this book as the script — do not invent a different answer. Step 1: generate the reference stills from the Reference Image Prompts page, in order, and check each against the Character & Style Lock. Step 2: build the six clips in Google Flow, one per Video Prompt page, using Frames-to-Video from the checked stills, one tiny action per clip, narration generated inside each clip using the locked voice. Step 3: assemble the clips in order 1-6, keep the question on screen until the reveal clip, captions in the series style, no dead air. Step 4: run the Edit Checklist page and fix every failure before export. Deliver a 1080x1920 MP4.

VOICE LOCK — one warm American male narrator, 30-35, calm and confident, slightly amused at the question beats, dead serious at the reveal. Same voice, same pace, every clip. The narration is generated INSIDE each Flow clip; listen-check every clip and regenerate only failures.

NARRATION SCRIPT

Six lines, about ten seconds each — sixty seconds in total. Record or generate them exactly as written.

LINE 1 · 0:00
"Four people. One narrow bridge. One torch. And the torch dies in seventeen minutes."

LINE 2 · 0:10
"They cross in one, two, five and ten minutes. Two together move at the slower pace — and someone must carry the torch back."

LINE 3 · 0:20
"The obvious plan — fastest person ferries everyone — takes nineteen minutes. The torch dies with one traveller stranded."

LINE 4 · 0:30
"Find a seventeen-minute schedule. Write it in the comments before the reveal."

LINE 5 · 0:40
"Send the one and the two across. The one returns. Now the trick: send the five and the ten together — the slow crossing hides inside itself."

LINE 6 · 0:50
"The two returns, the fast pair crosses last, and the torch dies exactly as they arrive. Seventeen. Follow for daily riddles."

VOICE LOCK — one warm American male narrator, 30-35, calm and confident, slightly amused at the question beats, dead serious at the reveal. Same voice, same pace, every clip. The narration is generated INSIDE each Flow clip; listen-check every clip and regenerate only failures.

THE THUMBNAIL

THE IDEA

The rope bridge at night, two slow silhouettes crossing together under one dying torch. Edit-drawn text: '17 MINUTES'.

IMAGE PROMPT

Flat 2D storybook illustration, vertical 9:16: a narrow rope bridge over a dark gorge at night, two travellers crossing side by side with a single low torch flame between them, deep navy palette, the top third left dark and empty for title text, no text in the image.

Rules: the question, never the answer. Three words or fewer of big text, drawn in editing — generated lettering garbles. Check it at profile-picture size before posting.

POSTING COPY

TITLE OPTIONS — pick one:

TITLE
Cross the Bridge in 17 Minutes — Or the Torch Dies

TITLE
1, 2, 5, 10 and One Torch (Bridge Puzzle)

TITLE
The Schedule With Zero Minutes to Spare

CAPTION — first line is the question
Four walkers, one torch, 17 minutes — and the obvious plan takes 19. Post your crossing schedule BEFORE the reveal. New riddle every day.

PINNED COMMENT
Post your full schedule with the running total BEFORE the reveal. Totals must land on 17.

Hashtags: #riddle #logicpuzzle #brainteaser #bridgepuzzle #puzzle #dailypuzzle

EDIT CHECKLIST

Nothing posts until every line passes.

CHECK
Frame-check every beat: characters match the lock, no drift, no warped hands or faces.

CHECK
Every number and word on screen is drawn in editing and read back — generated text is never trusted.

CHECK
The question stays on screen until the reveal beat; the answer never appears early — not in a caption, not in a frame.

CHECK
Listen to the full cut: one voice throughout, no dead air, no clip where the narration went missing.

CHECK
The reveal lands in the final seconds; the last frame carries the follow prompt.

CHECK
Thumbnail checked small; title and caption lead with the question, never the answer.

AI — WHO DOES WHAT

Every step of this book's video, and whose job it is.

THE AGENT (Antigravity)
Reads this book, plans the shots, writes the generation queue, assembles the edit, runs the checklist.

GOOGLE FLOW
Generates the reference stills, then the six clips with the narration inside each clip.

THE EDITOR (you, or the agent)
Draws all on-screen text and numbers, sets captions, checks every frame and every second of audio.

THE CHANNEL
Posts with the title, caption and pinned comment from the Posting Copy page — question first, answer never.

Part 2 idea: The mirror hunt: there is a second 17-minute schedule where the 2-minute walker makes the first return instead. Challenge viewers to find it before Part 2 posts it.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

One riddle, taken seriously: a verified answer, a locked visual style, and the complete route from page to posted video — script, narration, image prompts, video prompts, thumbnail and posting copy, all in one pack.

OWNERSHIP
This book — its text, structure and design — is owned by OTT TITANS. Reading or downloading it grants you the right to enjoy it and to produce your own version of the riddle video on your own channels. It never transfers ownership of the book.

The riddle itself is a classic that has travelled for years. This pack — its words, structure and production system — is the original work.

CASE CLOSED

1 and 2 cross (2). 1 returns (1). 5 and 10 cross together (10). 2 returns (2). 1 and 2 cross (2). Total: exactly 17.

A new riddle lands every day. Solve the next one before the reveal.

— END OF BOOK —